



KERNA



KERNA ESCALATION ENGINE — FINAL SPEC (v1)



Severity Model (Locked)

You chose:

LOW
MEDIUM
HIGH

Severity Meaning

Level	Meaning	Founder visibility
LOW	monitor only	optional
MEDIUM	needs attention	visible
HIGH	intervention required	immediate



Threshold Configuration (System Settings)

These must be **admin-editable variables**, not hardcoded.

```
ESCALATION_CONFIG = {  
  client_rejection_threshold: 3,  
  payment_overdue_days: 10,  
  poc_inactive_days: 1,  
}
```

Future-proof: store in DB table `system_settings`.

AUTO-ESCALATION RULES

Rule 1 — Client Rejection Loop

Trigger

When:

client_rejection_count >= 3

Escalation

type: CLIENT_DISPUTE

severity: MEDIUM

owner: POC

notify: Founder + POC

Reason

Signals friction but not crisis yet.

Rule 2 — Payment Overdue

Trigger

payment_due_date + 10 days < today
AND payment_status != PAID

Escalation

type: PAYMENT_RISK

severity: HIGH

owner: POC

notify: Founder + POC (real-time)

Why HIGH

Because cash flow risk = business risk.

Good call by you.

Rule 3 — POC Inactivity (Critical)

You made this aggressive. I like it.

Trigger

POC_last_activity > 1 day

Escalation

type: POC_INACTIVE

severity: HIGH

owner: Founder

notify: Founder (real-time)

Important nuance

System should ALSO create a softer alert at 12 hours (recommended future enhancement).

ALERT vs ESCALATION (Clear Boundary)

Sneha must implement this distinction.

Alerts (system only)

Examples:

- approval pending
- client inactive 2 days
- deadline approaching

👉 Alerts do NOT create escalation records.

Escalations (serious)

Only when:

- thresholds breached
- manual escalate
- dispute flow

👉 These create records in `escalations` table.

🧠 MANUAL ESCALATION (Human Trigger)

Who Can Escalate

Role	Allowed
POC	✓
Founder	✓
System	✓
Client	✗ (indirect only)
Dev/Design	✗

This matches your governance philosophy.

Manual Escalation Form (UI Requirement)

Sneha must build modal:

Fields

- escalation type (dropdown)
 - severity (auto-suggest but editable by founder only)
 - reason (required textarea)
 - related project
 - attachments (optional)
-



ESCALATION LIFECYCLE (DB ENUM)

escalation_status:

- OPEN
 - UNDER_REVIEW
 - ACTION_IN_PROGRESS
 - RESOLVED
 - DISMISSED
-

State Rules

From	Allowed To
OPEN	UNDER_REVIEW
UNDER_REVIEW	ACTION_IN_PROGRESS
ACTION_IN_PROGRESS	RESOLVED
ANY	DISMISSED

All transitions must be audit logged.

Immutable history. Always.



NOTIFICATION POLICY (You chose BOTH)

Real-Time Notifications

Send immediately for:

- HIGH severity
 - POC inactive
 - payment overdue
-

Daily Digest

Send summary for:

- LOW
- MEDIUM
- aging escalations

Digest goes to founders + management.

FOUNDER ESCALATION CENTER (UI SPEC)

Route

/app/escalations

Table Columns (Required)

- Escalation ID
 - Project Name
 - Client
 - Type
 - Severity (color coded)
 - Trigger Source (system/manual)
 - Owner
 - Age timer
 - Status
 - Quick actions
-

Color Mapping (Design System aligned)

Severity	Color
LOW	neutral gray
MEDIUM	warning (#F4B942)
HIGH	error (#E74C3C)

Use your teal only for **selection/active states**, not severity.

Premium restraint.

PROJECT-LEVEL ESCALATION WIDGET

Inside project dashboard:

Must show

- Active escalation count
- Highest severity badge
- “View Details” CTA

Visible to:

- POC
- Founder
- Management (read-only)

Not visible to client.



AUDIT REQUIREMENTS (Critical)

Every escalation event must log:

```
{  
  escalation_id,  
  action,  
  actor_id,  
  actor_role,  
  timestamp,  
  previous_state,  
  new_state,  
  notes  
}
```

You asked for immutable logs.

This is the spine.